Pragya's SEO work: the verdict

Five weekly reports, 13 October to 9 November 2026. Every link opened and checked on 13 November, then compared with your leads, sales and traffic.

Recommendation: end the contract with Pragya this week. Keep doing SEO, but in house and aimed at parents searching for a tutor. Move the £70 a week to something you can measure in pounds.

1. What the £70 a week bought

Report	Links reported	Could help rankings	Ignored by Google	No link to your site	Dead or would not open
13 October	27	10	11	4	2
19 October	29	10	11	4	4
27 October	20	5	10	2	3
2 November	22	7	6	4	5
9 November	22	5	9	5	3
Total	**120**	**37**	**47**	**19**	**17**

"Ignored by Google" means the link is marked nofollow or the page tells Google not to index it. "No link" pages only link to her other placements. "Dead" pages were down, empty or behind a bot wall. Two listings were reported twice, so these are 118 different pages.

- **None of the 118 is on the list of 14 UK parent and education sites** she was given on 2 October. That list was the whole brief.
- **30 of the 37 useful links are pages she set up herself** on free platforms under your name (Blogspot, WordPress, Substack, Wikidot, Webflow and so on). Nobody reads them, and Google gives them almost no weight.
- **The other 7 are open-submission sites anyone can post on.** Two are bookmarking sites, one is a directory, and three are on Whizolosophy, filed under "Crime and Punishment" and "Poetry".
- **30 links she reported as "Do Follow" are not.** They are nofollow, noindexed, missing or dead.
- **Your own website articles were copied word for word.** Eight pages copy between 20% and 90% of the predicted grades article (Pearltrees, Paragraph, Anotepad, Weebly, Webflow, Ganjing World, WriteUpCafe). The October reports used the website versions, not the rewritten packs you supplied. A copy on a stronger site can outrank your own page. The November reports did switch to the approved rewrites.
- **Privacy is clean.** No listing shows your home address. They say "Surrey, London" or show the business email only.

2. Did any of it bring in money?

Question	Answer	Source

Leads ever traced to any of her sites	0	Every MailerLite lead with a recorded source (source recording started 3 October)
Diagnostic leads from Google, 3 October to 13 November	0 recorded	MailerLite. At most 6 more could have started on Google, because the tracking cannot see past the first page.
Her referral traffic, last measured	20 to 30 visits a month, 0 sign-ups	GA4, 28 days to 23 September
Paying Academy members	9	5 came through the KCL workshop. The other 4 joined 5 to 7 November with no source recorded. None came from Google.
On page 1 for "A-level tutor", "A-level chemistry tutor", "A-level biology tutor"?	No, not seen in any check	Web search spot checks on 13 November. These are estimates, not Search Console. The page is held by The Profs, MyTutor, Tutorful, GoStudent, StudyMind and Tutopiya.
Search Console today	Not read since 17 September	Needs a session on your Mac

The honest summary: **organic search is working for visibility, and that came from the content written in house.** Clicks were up about 4x and impressions about 10x by mid September, with an average position on page 1. Pragya's links are not the reason. The searches you rank for are students looking for planners, resits and appeals, and they are not your buyers. Revision tracker sign-ups (26 since 13 October) are students too.

To compare cost per result: one talk at KCL produced at least five paying families. About £1,000 spent with Pragya since late July (15 weeks at about £70) has produced no lead we can trace.

3. Why her approach cannot reach your goal

1. **The buyer search is a marketplace fight.** Parents typing "A-level tutor" get The Profs, MyTutor and Tutorful, established sites with years of links and reviews behind them. Bulk profile and bookmarking links will never close that gap.
2. **Google is built to ignore this kind of link.** Self-made blogs, nofollow posts and noindexed pages are the textbook low-value link. At best they do nothing. Copied articles can work against you.
3. **The brief was changed three times and the output stayed the same.** On 24 September you set the condition that real UK education and parenting placements had to start landing. On 2 October target-finding moved in house to make that easy. Six weeks later there are none.

4. What to do next, in order

1. **End the contract this week.** Send the reply below, then end the contract in Upwork yourself. Ask her for the list of accounts made in your name, and for the copied website articles to come down.
2. **Read Search Console once, from your Mac.** Start a session in the Claude desktop app and say "run the SEO optimiser". It takes about five minutes and records where every page stands now, so you can see that nothing drops after she stops.
3. **Put the £70 a week into a buyer test.** Run Google Ads on tutor searches at £10 a day for three weeks. The spec is already written (content/google-ads/2026-10-02-search-test.md). It answers the real question directly: do parents searching for a tutor book calls with you? If they do, organic work on those terms is worth chasing. If they don't, you've saved months.
4. **Keep the in-house content engine, pointed at parents.** The subject tutoring pages and parent articles should go after "A-level tutor for my child" searches, with every one leading to the diagnostic and the free call.
5. **Get the few links that matter yourself.** One article on The Parents' Guide To or Families Online is worth more than all 118 of these. The outreach emails are already drafted (content/seo/2026-08-09-listicle-outreach-drafts.md).
6. **Fix the lead tracking.** Record a visitor's source on the first page they land on, so a Google reader who goes from a blog post to the diagnostic is credited to Google. This is a small change that is ready to build on your go.

5. Your reply to Pragya (paste into Upwork)

> Hi Pragya,
>
> Thank you for the five reports from 13 October to 9 November, and for all the hours behind them. I've now gone through every link myself and checked them against our leads and sales.
>
> I've decided to end our SEO work together at the end of this week.
>
> I want to be straight with you about why. In September I said the work could only continue if we started getting placements on UK education and parenting sites, and on 2 October we sent you a list of 14 of those sites to work from. None of the 118 links in these reports is on that list. Most of them are pages we set up ourselves on free platforms, and around half are nofollow or set to noindex, so Google doesn't count them. We also haven't been able to trace a single enquiry or sign-up to any of them, and that's the measure that matters for a small business like mine.

Before we close, I'd be grateful for two things:

1. Please take down the copies of our website articles that went up word for word in October. They compete with our own pages. The ones I found are on Pearltrees, Paragraph, Anotepad, Weebly, Webflow, Ganjing World and WriteUpCafe. The rewritten versions from our article packs can stay.

2. Please send me a list of every account you created under the A-Level Accelerators name (Blogspot, WordPress, Substack, Notion, Wikidot, the directory profiles and so on), with the email address each one is registered to, so I can take them over.

Thank you again for your effort and for always being quick to reply. I wish you all the best with your other clients.

Kind regards,
Waleed

Method: 118 unique URLs from the five spreadsheets were fetched directly and in a real browser on 13 November 2026. Each was checked for a live link to alevelaccelerators.com, its nofollow status, the page's robots setting and any address data. Lead data comes from the MailerLite lead groups, all time. GA4 figures come from Google's monthly report emails and the 23 September acquisition read. Search rankings are web-search spot checks, labelled as estimates. Search Console was not available this session.